

Oil to stay above \$100 on infrastructure risks

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The US-Iran standoff and the risk of continued attacks against Saudi energy infrastructure will keep oil prices above \$100 in the near term. US President

Daily Brief

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summary

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The US-Iran standoff and the risk of continued attacks against Saudi energy infrastructure will keep oil prices above \$100 in the near term.

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US President Donald Trump will likely oppose any form of AI slowdown.

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Polls in the Brazilian election appear to be stabilizing, maintaining President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva's slight advantage.

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The BRICS Summit in India is setting the stage for China's digital standards push.

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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, BRICS, MENA, Brazil, China, France, India, Indonesia, geoeconomics, geo-technology, and oil.

the top line

Oil—Middle East's deepening crisis will keep crude prices above \$100

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A successful drone attack on the East-West pipeline in Saudi Arabia has cut 4 million barrels per day (bpd) from the market, causing prices to soar above \$100 per barrel for Brent.

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Saudi Arabia is likely to repair the damage that shut down the pipeline, but the timeline is unclear and the risk of continued attack will remain acute.

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Tanker attacks will keep pushing up shipping rates, as the conflict is turning into a broader shipping crisis.

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[Read more here](#) . Reach out to discuss: mena@eurasiagroup.net .

Goeconomics, Geo-technology—Chart of the day: Despite US efforts, Chinese models remain only six months behind

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Reach out to discuss: goeconomics@eurasiagroup.net .

Brazil—Polls point to stabilization, keeping Lula slightly favored

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The latest polling round shows that Lula's recent downward trajectory in runoff voting intentions has leveled off. On 8 September, the rolling average of all polls showed Senator Flavio Bolsonaro ahead by 0.5 points; now, he is now 0.1 points behind Lula.

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Lula's approval ratings have also stopped dropping, suggesting the effects of corruption scandals have bottomed out. The latest polls put his approval back at 45.7%. The slight uptick is a relief for the Workers' Party campaign, even if it is too early to conclude his numbers are on a path to recovery.

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EG puts Lula's winning odds at 55% owing to incumbency advantages. With six weeks to go until the runoff, his campaign also appears to be finding its footing after a weak start, with the Workers' Party now on the offensive.

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EG has also lowered the chances of a candidate other than Bolsonaro reaching the runoff against Lula from 30% to 20% and will reduce these odds further if these candidates do not rise in the polls by early next week.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net .

BRICS, India, China—BRICS summit sets stage for China's digital standards push

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Indian diplomats were able to persuade Iran and the UAE to agree to language that criticized Israel by name for military action against Lebanon and expressed concerns about strikes on nuclear targets, but only those under international safeguards. "Aggression" was criticized in generic terms but without naming the US.

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Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Xi Jinping held a bilateral meeting during the summit. Beijing sees a chance to dilute New Delhi's recent strategic tilt toward Washington. The two countries have taken modest steps to normalize relations, but there is almost no trust (see note , 28 August).

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A long-term Indian goal has been to ensure the BRICS did not move toward centralized financial and trade integration that would enhance China's already dominant position in the grouping. At this summit, however, India notably failed to secure support for linking BRICS digital payment systems through a network of bilateral agreements.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: china@eurasiagroup.net .

France—Le Pen's rift with Bardella threatens to undermine her credibility

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Marine Le Pen still dominates opinion polls for both the first and second rounds of the presidential election on 18 April and 2 May, but a rift with her de facto number two, Jordan Bardella, has drawn attention to her contradictory economic policies.

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The recent election victory of the far-right Alternative for Germany (AfD) in Saxony-Anhalt is a double-edged sword for Le Pen: Though it confirms a rising tide of nationalist populism in Europe, the party's soft-pedaling of Germany's Nazi past may push older French voters toward more mainstream candidates.

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EG continues to assign a 35% probability to a Le Pen victory and 40% odds to the strongest establishment candidate, the former centrist prime minister Edouard Philippe.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: europe@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

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15 September 8:00 PM ET—Taiwan elections and risk outlook. Register here .

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16 September 9:30 AM ET—Brazil update. Register here .

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16 September 2:00 AM ET—Yen and Treasuries markets turmoil, the global geoeconomic outlook. Register here .

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18 September 8:00 AM ET—Brazil's VAT reform: what changes in 2027 - A chat with João Nobre, Senior Advisor to the Minister of Finance. Register here .

eg in depth

Indonesia—New Finance Minister offers broad fiscal continuity: President Prabowo Subianto yesterday replaced Finance Minister Purbaya Yudhi Sadewa with Vice Finance Minister Suahasil Nazara, after facing significant pressures for some time. The easing of pressure on the rupiah recently may have given the president a less risky chance to make the switch. Suahasil is a credible technocrat, less likely to shoot from the hip than Purbaya was and will probably be more willing to engage with international partners and investors. Broad fiscal continuity is expected, but a key watchpoint is whether Suahasil continues Purbaya's push to inject government funds into banks to boost lending. This created friction with Bank Indonesia, as the finance ministry's liquidity measures sometimes conflicted with the central bank's monetary operations and efforts to manage the rupiah. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: southeastasia@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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15 September: Events: US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent to appear before the House Financial Services Committee for annual testimony on the international financial system.

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16 September: Data: Eurozone IP, Japan trade, and UK CPI; Central bank decisions: Brazil and US.

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17 September: Data: Eurozone CPI; Central bank decisions: UK.

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18 September: Events: NATO Military Committee Conference begins in Copenhagen, through 19 September; Data: Japan CPI, and US IP; Central bank decision: Japan.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Martina Silva, Blaise Hanson, and Trista Kelley.

closing quip

"AI brings risks, and because it is such a powerful technology, these risks are serious ... A race to the bottom, spurred by commercial incentives, can make these risks more acute."—Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei wrote in an essay published on Saturday, on X, titled "We Must Pace the Frontier."

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